ruined landscape of domed tombs and its melancholy atmosphere of past glory. And with good reason, because this was India's Mecca, the *karbala* of Islam in the Deccan, a ghost city of the dead where some of its greatest saints and rulers lie buried.

In 1850 one of those visitors was the young English watercolourist William Carpenter, who lingered long enough to draw a sketch of the graveyard's most famous occupant, Emperor Aurangzeb, laid to rest here in 1707. His drawing (see page 313) shows Aurangzeb's grave very much as the emperor had ordered it to be: unmarked, without decoration, and open to the sky. That is not how it is today. That grand imperialist Lord Curzon deemed the tomb unfit for a ruler of India and twisted the arm of the Nizam of Hyderabad, who, being the richest man in the world, was happy to pay for the marble screen that surrounds the tomb today.

Aurangzeb's tomb at Khuldabad still attracts a stream of visitors, and why not, since he is revered by millions of Sunni Muslims. Despite his murderous track record, which included the deposition and imprisonment of the emperor his father, the murder of his heretical, open-minded elder brother Dara – whose tragic story was recently re-enacted on the stage of London's National Theatre in Tanya Ronder's adaptation of Shahid Nadeem's moving drama *Dara* – and the disposal of other weaker brethren, to his many admirers the single-minded Aurangzeb was the greatest Muslim ruler India had ever known, the emir who imposed the steel frame of *Adl*, or 'divine justice' upon his empire.

Aurangzeb brought together five hundred Islamic scholars who followed the Hanafi school of jurisprudence to produce the landmark thirty-volume *Fatawa al-Hindiya* ('Islamic rulings on India'), better known throughout the Muslim world today as *Fatawa-e-Alamgiri*. This now became the main basis for the enforcement of sharia throughout South Asia